www.tntextbooks.in

International Herbarium

S.No	Herbarium	Year Established	Acronym	Number of specimens
1.	*Museum National d'Histoire Naturelle*, Paris, France	1635	P ,PC	10,000,000
2.	New York Botanical Garden, Bronx, New York, U.S.A	1891	NY	72,00,000
3.	Komarov Botanical Institute, St.Petersburg (Leningrad), Russia	1823	LE	71,60,000
4.	Royal Botanic Gardens, Kew, England, U.K	1841	K	70,00,000

National Herbarium

S.No	Herbarium	Year Established	Acronym	Number of specimens
1.	Madras Herbarium BSI campus, Coimbatore	1955	MH	4,08,776
2.	Central National Herbarium West Bengal	1795	CAL	2,00,000
3.	Jawaharlal Nehru Tropical Botanical Garden and Research Institute Thiruvananthapuram, Kerala	1979	TBGT	30,500
4.	Presidency College Herbarium, Chennai.	1844	PCM	15,000

Uses of Herbarium

1. Herbarium provides resource material for systematic research and studies.
2. It is a place for orderly arrangement of voucher specimens.
3. Voucher specimen serves as a reference for comparing doubtful newly collected fresh specimens.
4. Voucher specimens play a role in studies like floristic diversity, environmental assessment, ecological mechanisms and survey of unexplored areas.
5. Herbarium provides opportunity for documenting biodiversity and studies related to the field of ecology and conservation biology.

Kew Herbarium

Kew Garden is situated in South West London that houses the "largest and most diverse botanical and mycological collections in the world" founded in the year 1840. Living collection includes more than 30,000 different kinds of plants. While herbarium which is one of the largest in the world has over seven million preserved plant specimens. The library contains more than 7,50,000 volumes and the illustrations and also a collection of more than 1,75,000 prints, books, photographs, letters, manuscripts, periodicals, maps and botanical illustrations.